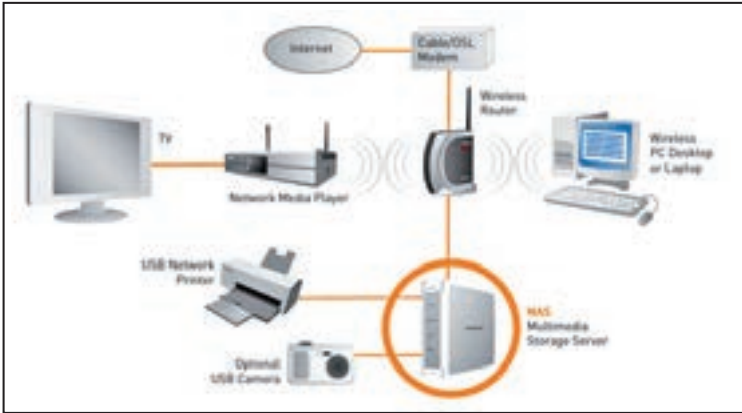




NAS and its network connections

computers and other devices. With a NAS you do not have to have your computer(s) powered on permanently – your data is always available on your network and easily accessible from multiple devices. It's also possible to 'convert' a modest computer into a dedicated NAS device – we'll be covering this in the latter chapters.

Four cool ways you can use your NAS

As we can make out, the principle purpose of the NAS, is to store and share files on the network. However, the utility of these cool devices doesn't simply end here.

There are a loads of other things you can do with your NAS:

► Streaming media to other computers from your NAS

If you have a home theatre PC, PlayStation 3, Xbox 360, or other UPnP-enabled device, you can stream media straight from your NAS with just a few tweaks.

The first thing you need to know about is Digital Media Adapter (DMA, also referred to as Digital Media Receiver). DMA provides the most elegant way to share audio, photo, and video files between your PC and your television. The DMA connects to your TV via HDMI, composite or component video outputs; and it connects to your network via ethernet or wirelessly. Once on the network, it can stream media from your network hard drive – assuming the NAS box has an UPnP (Universal Plug and Play) media server embedded, as most of them invariably do. You